

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

Top Projects and Ecosystem Shifts

A data-driven overview of the most-starred JavaScript projects in 2024, highlighting the dominance of shadcn/ui, the rise of htmx, and major framework evolutions.

Methodology: GitHub stars added in 2024 · Source: risingstars.js.org/2024

shadcn/ui

+38.0k stars

Excalidraw

+27.0k stars

htmx

+16.8k stars

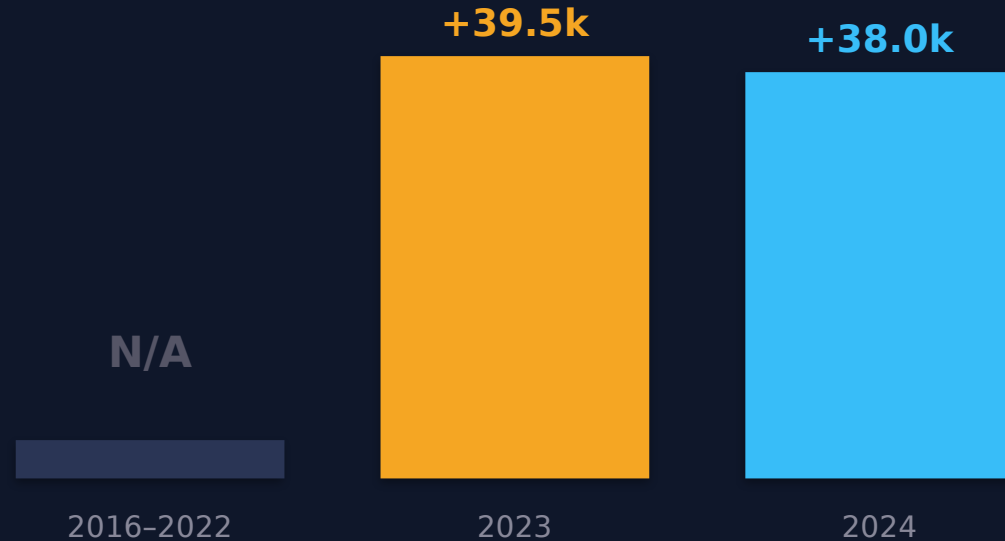
Overall Top 10: shadcn/ui Leads with +38k Stars

GitHub stars added in 2024 — projects curated by Best of JS



shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Year

YEARLY STAR GROWTH



Total: 77.5k stars · Created January 2023

KEY 2024 ADDITIONS

Charts

Powered by Recharts integration

Themes

CSS variable generation system

Blocks

Layout collections for typical web apps

Sidebar

New responsive sidebar component

CLI v2

Supports Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos

Registry

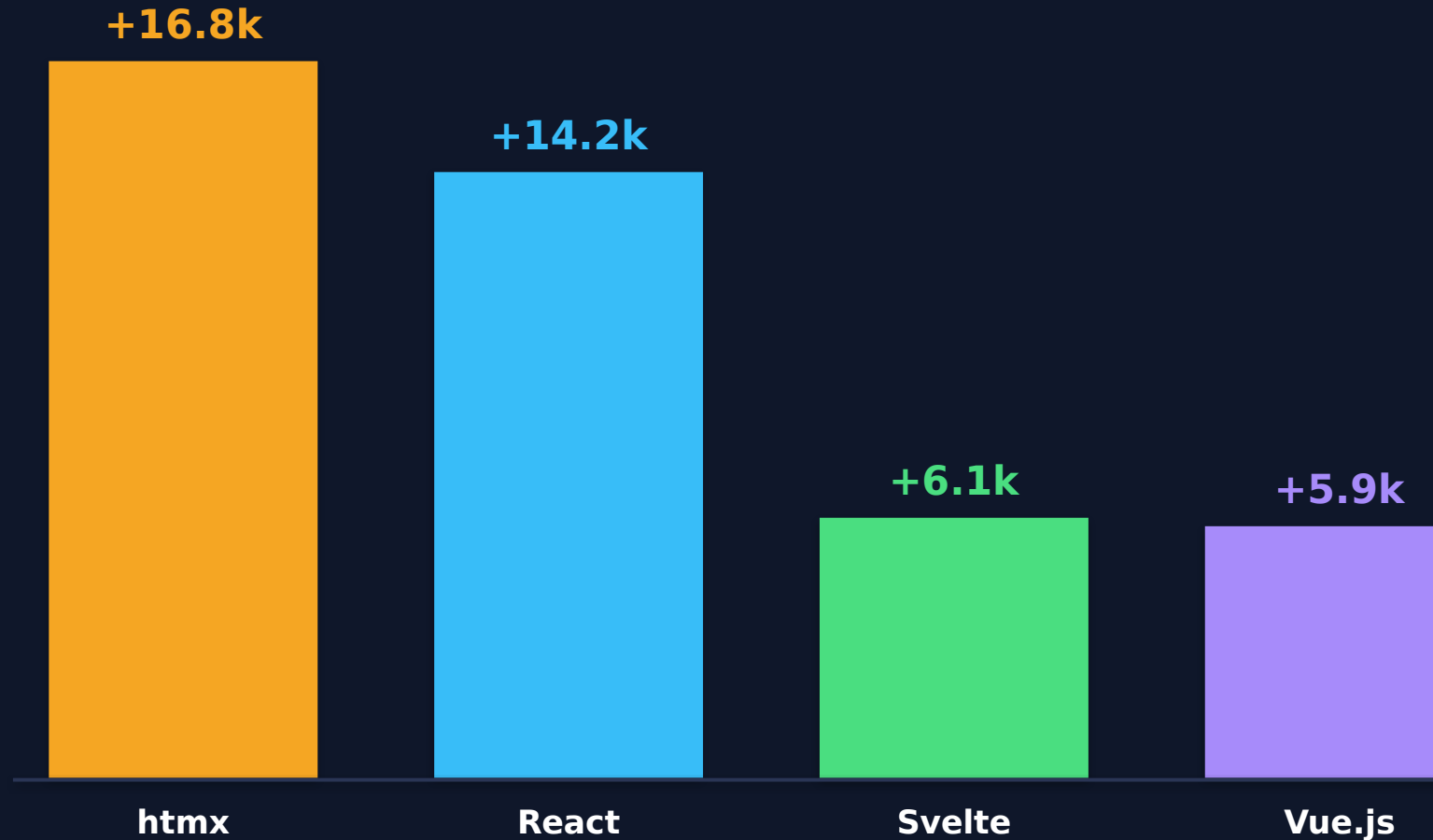
Ecosystem of derivative libraries (Motion-Primitives, Magic UI)

v0

The "own your components" model — copy-paste code you can fully customize — proved its staying power. The new CLI and registry system turn shadcn/ui from a component library into an ecosystem platform.

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added

Stars added in 2024 — front-end frameworks category



htmx — HTML-first

Extends HTML with hx-* attributes for AJAX & interactivity without JS. Rose from #2 (2023) → #1 (2024). Ideal for server-driven apps.

React 19 — 3 years in the making

Server Components, Server Functions, Custom Elements support, new hooks. Evolving from library → "specification for frameworks."

Svelte 5 — Runes for reactivity

Highest positive opinion in State of JS survey.

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

#1	shadcn/ui Beautifully designed copy-paste components		+38.0k
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#2	Excalidraw Virtual whiteboard for hand-drawn diagrams		+27.0k
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#3	Payload Open-source fullstack Next.js framework		+14.4k
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#4	Magic UI Animated React component library		+13.2k
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#5	Next.js The React framework for production		+12.1k
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React is evolving from a library into "a specification for frameworks" — Server Components and Server Functions mean Next.js, Remix, and others now interpret React's primitives differently. The ecosystem is thriving around this shift.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead

1

Nuxt

Full-stack Vue framework with SSR & file-based routing

+6.2k

2

PrimeVue

Rich UI component suite for Vue

+5.4k

3

Slidev

Developer-focused presentation slides in Markdown

+4.7k

4

shadcn-vue

shadcn/ui component port for Vue

+4.1k

5

VitePress

Static site generator powered by Vite & Vue

+3.7k

Vue 3.5 reworked its reactivity system — the lighter alien-signals approach has already landed in the main branch. The wave of high-quality UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) signals a confident, maturing ecosystem.

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser Innovation

Shape 2024

AI-Powered Tools

n8n +17.0k

Fair-code workflow automation with native AI

Flowise +14.5k

Drag & drop UI for custom LLM flows

AFFiNE +19.6k

Knowledge base with AI capabilities

Desktop & Mobile

Tauri +15.9k

Lighter desktop/mobile apps with web tech

Browser Innovation

PGlite —

Postgres running via WebAssembly

WebVM —

Full virtual machine in the browser

Backend-as-a-Service

Supabase +14.5k

Open-source Firebase alternative

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

1 Component ownership beats imports

shadcn/ui's copy-paste model proved its staying power for a second year (77.5k total stars). Developers want to own and customize their component code, not depend on opaque packages.

2 HTML-first is serious

htmx overtook React as #1 front-end framework by stars added, validating server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures for a growing segment of web applications.

3 React is becoming a framework specification

With Server Components and Server Functions in React 19, multiple frameworks now interpret React's primitives differently — React is less a library and more a spec.

4 AI integration is table stakes

Four of the top 10 overall projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities. AI features are expected, not exceptional.

5 Vue's ecosystem signals maturity

A wave of high-quality UI libraries and the Vue 3.5 reactivity overhaul signal a confident, maturing Vue ecosystem ready for enterprise adoption.

→ Looking ahead to 2025: watch for AI-native dev tools, continued framework spec convergence, and Wasm-powered browser capabilities.